LESSON PLAN · WEB DEVELOPMENT (GR 6–8) BEGINNER: WEB CREATORS · LEVEL 1

Lesson 3: CSS colours, fonts and boxes

Module 1 | 60 minutes | CSS rules, box model | Grades 6–11 · ages 11–16

Objective: Style a web page with CSS rules for colours, fonts, padding, borders and margins.

Success criteria

- I can write a CSS rule with a selector and property.
- I can change text and background colours.
- I can change the font and its size.
- I can use padding, border and margin on a box.

Key vocabulary

- **CSS**: The language that styles a web page: colours, fonts, spacing.
- **selector**: The part of a rule that picks what to style, like h1.
- **property**: What you want to change, like color.
- **value**: What you change it to, like orange.
- **padding**: Space inside a box, between content and border.
- **margin**: Space outside a box.

You will need

- Projector with Kitabash (lesson video, Web Lab)
- Devices: 1 per learner, with a keyboard
- Printed worksheet (optional)
- Project files: l03-diwali-mela-notice.html, l03-teacher-demo.md

Timed lesson plan (60 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up game: Human CSS**	Play Human CSS: call out rules for colours, then build a human box with a skipping-rope border.
5 min	**Hook and video**	Show the hook rule. Poll: “What colour should our heading be?” Play the video; pause at “Easy to read, or hard to read?” for a thumbs vote.
10 min	**Live demo and build-along**	Run the demo as written, then build the Diwali mela notice together. Thumbs check after the box step.
8 min	**Challenge and games**	Web Lab: paint the page, then Predict the colours, the property match and Order it: build a CSS rule. Quick race: first to finish the order game wins.
17 min	**Project in pairs**	Breakout rooms: pairs design a school event poster. Navigator checks every rule has a colon and semicolon; swap every 5 minutes.

5 min	**Probe**	New situation: squashed words. Discuss padding vs margin with a quick drawing on the whiteboard.
6 min	**Show-and-tell: poster gallery**	Gallery walk: learners share posters one after another; class votes “easiest to read from far away” with reactions.
4 min	**Wrap-up and exit ticket**	Fist-to-five on the success criteria. Exit ticket: the dark-blue paragraph rule.

Unplugged warm-up

Human CSS (5 min game): the teacher is the browser. Learners call out rules in the right shape — “h1, color, red!” — and the teacher holds up the matching coloured paper. Then three learners stand as a box: the middle one is the content, an arm’s-length gap is the padding, a skipping rope held around them is the border, and the space to the next group is the margin.

Teaching the idea

CSS controls how HTML looks. We put rules in a style tag. Each rule has a selector (what to style) and declarations inside curly brackets: property, colon, value, semicolon. color is text colour and background-color paints behind it. font-family picks a font, with a backup. Every element is a box: padding is inside the border, border is the line, and margin is outside.

Analogy: HTML is the house’s bricks and rooms; CSS is the paint, curtains and furniture. A box is a framed photo: padding is the mount around the photo, the border is the frame, and margin is the wall space between frames.

Live demo: 1) Start with an h1 and a p from last lesson. Type an empty <style> </style> block at the top and explain: HTML says what things are, CSS says how they look. 2) Inside it type h1 { color: orange; } and watch the heading change. Name the selector, the property and the value. 3) Add body { background-color: lightyellow; } and show the whole page change. 4) Add font-family: Arial, sans-serif; to body. Explain the second font is a backup. 5) Make a p with a border: 3px solid orange; then add padding: 16px; and margin: 20px; one at a time. Point to the space INSIDE the border (padding) and OUTSIDE it (margin). 6) Delete the colon in color: orange and show the rule stops working. Put it back.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
What is the difference between HTML and CSS?	HTML says what things are; CSS says how they look.
Name the three parts of a CSS rule.	Selector, property, value.
What happens if you forget the colon?	The browser cannot read that line and skips it.
Padding or margin: which is inside the border?	Padding is inside; margin is outside.
Why add sans-serif after Arial?	It is a backup if Arial is not on the computer.

Differentiation

Support
Show a colour-name cheat sheet (orange, teal, navy, gold, lightyellow). Let learners copy the build-along CSS and change only the values.

Stretch
Use border-radius for rounded corners, text-align: center for the whole poster, and try a Google-style colour picker to find hex codes.

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
color with a u (colour) works	CSS uses American spelling: color. “colour” is ignored.
background changes the text colour	background-color is behind the text; color is the text itself.
Padding and margin are the same	Padding is inside the border; margin is outside it.
CSS goes anywhere in the page as plain text	CSS goes inside a style tag (or a style attribute), or it shows up as words on the page.

Assessment

Use the Code Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

Exit ticket
Write a CSS rule that makes every paragraph dark blue with 10px of padding.

Homework
Restyle your “All about me” page from lesson 1 with a style tag: a background colour, a font and one framed box. Ask someone at home to pick their favourite colour scheme.

Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. Web Lab: paint the page (perform · web lab)

Goals checked: Has a style tag · Changes colours · Changes the font

One solution:

```
<style>
  body {
    background-color: #e8f8f5;
    font-family: Verdana, sans-serif;
  }
  h1 { color: darkgreen; }
</style>
<h1>Sports Day</h1>
<p>Races, relays and a tug of war. Wear your house colours!</p>
```

2. Predict the colours (perform · code output)

3. Match each CSS property to what it changes (perform · matching)

color → The colour of the text · background-color → The colour behind the text · font-family → The typeface, like Arial · padding → Space inside the box, around the words · border → The line around the box · margin → Space outside the box

4. Order it: build a CSS rule (perform · ordering)

Order: h1 (the selector) → { (open the curly bracket) → color (the property) → : (a colon) → orange (the value) → ; (a semicolon) → } (close the curly bracket)

5. Project: school event poster (perform · web lab)

Goals checked: Has a big title · Has at least two paragraphs · Uses colour and a font · Frames a box · Has enough details

Example page:

```
<style>
  body {
    background-color: #fff4e0;
    font-family: Verdana, sans-serif;
    text-align: center;
  }
  h1 {
    color: #d35400;
    font-size: 44px;
    margin: 10px;
  }
  h2 {
    color: #1a5276;
  }
  p {
    color: #333333;
    font-size: 18px;
  }
  .details {
    background-color: white;
    border: 4px dashed #d35400;
    padding: 20px;
    margin: 20px auto;
    width: 70%;
  }
</style>

<h1>Science Fair 2026</h1>
<h2>Build it. Test it. Show it!</h2>
<div class="details">
  <p>Come and see robots, volcanoes and solar cookers made by our students.</p>
  <p>Saturday morning in the school hall. Entry is free for everyone.</p>
</div>
<p>Poster designed by the Class 7 Coding Club</p>
```

6. New situation: squashed words (probe · multiple choice)

Answer: padding

Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** CSS = The language that styles a web page: colours, fonts, spacing. · selector = The part of a rule that picks what to style, like h1. · property = What you want to change, like color. · value = What you change it to, like orange.
2. **Plan your page:** Goals: Has a style tag; Changes colours; Changes the font.
3. **Predict the colours:** A. Only “Bring your colours!”

4. **Match each CSS property to what it changes:** color → The colour of the text · background-color → The colour behind the text · font-family → The typeface, like Arial · padding → Space inside the box, around the words · border → The line around the box · margin → Space outside the box
5. **Order it: build a CSS rule:** 1 h1 (the selector) · 2 { (open the curly bracket) · 3 color (the property) · 4 : (a colon) · 5 orange (the value) · 6 ; (a semicolon) · 7 } (close the curly bracket)

Kitabash original curriculum.